

- ▶ Press [Win]+[W] to search for settings in the start screen, type “group policy” and press enter.
- ▶ In the window that opens up drill down to Computer Configuration>Windows Settings>Security Settings>Local Policies>Security Options
- ▶ In the right hand area near the bottom you will find the policy called “User Account Control: Run all administrators in Admin Approval Mode”; double click this setting.
- ▶ In the dialog that opens up, select Disabled, and click OK.
- ▶ Windows will warn you that the system’s security has been reduced and will prompt you to restart.

Once you have restarted, the new settings will apply. Applications will launch with admin privileges by default and Metro apps will be disabled.

Enable Hyper-V

If you are running Windows 8 Pro, you will be pleased to know that your OS includes a pretty advanced virtualization software called Hyper-V. Hyper-V is comparable to software like VMWare Workstation and Oracle VirtualBox.

Hyper-V is included with Windows, but does not come installed by default. Installing it is simple though, all you need to do is the following:

Press [Win]+[W] to search for settings in the start screen, and type “features” one of the results should be called “Turn Windows features on or off”, launch it.

A dialog will show up that allows you to enable and disable a number of Windows features, Hyper-V is one, select it and click OK.

Windows will now begin installing the software, and it should be available after a reboot.

You should note that installing Hyper-V may make it impossible to install other virtualization software like VMWare Player or Workstation.

Use BitLocker to Encrypt Your Files

NTFS has an extensive system of permissions that allows you to restrict who can access, view, read or otherwise interact with a particular file. Unfortunately if someone gets access to your physical drive, NTFS permissions mean diddlysquat since they are enforced by software and can be easily overridden.

Windows has however, since Vista, included a tool called BitLocker for encrypting your entire hard drive. Using BitLocker you can lock any